

Impact Medium · Difficulty Medium · Misuse risk The move fails when you overreach - stacking several needs, choosing a load

THE MOVE

Cue -> feeling -> likely need -> tentative phrase -> pause -> follow or release. -> Basic: "It sounds like you are [feeling] because you needed [need]." -> Softer: "I might be reading this wrong, but part of the [feeling] is needing [need]." -> ?

START HERE

Name one feeling plus one likely need in a single tentative sentence, then pause and let them accept, adjust, or decline - e.g. "It sounds frustrating because you needed clearer next steps."

SAY THIS

Quick	<i>"It sounds frustrating because you needed clearer next steps."</i>
Social / personal	<i>"It sounds like you're disappointed because you wanted to feel included earlier."</i>
Workplace / decision	<i>"It sounds like the frustration is about needing clearer ownership before the deadline."</i>
Naming the need	<i>"It sounds like what mattered was needing respect for that boundary."</i>
Conflict / repair	<i>"It sounds like you felt hurt because you needed your side to be taken seriously."</i>
High-pressure	<i>"It sounds like the immediate need is safety and clarity."</i>

AVOID

- The person only wants direct information or a fast decision
- You have too little evidence to infer a need
- The wording would sound clinical, patronising, or too intimate for the relationship

REMEMBER

Name one feeling plus one need, then stop.